



The \$tôkEx Algorithm

A continuous, order-book-free exchange mechanism
between two fungible assets

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AI contribution statement

This document was prepared with the assistance of Milu, an AI agent (built on Anthropic’s Claude models) integrated into the Smoothop project. Milu contributed to the mathematical formalization, to the machine-checked proofs (Lean 4 / mathlib) and numerical verification of the claims herein, and to the drafting of the text, under the direction and review of the human author, who is solely responsible for its content.

Name and pronunciation

The name \$tôkEx juxtaposes the two currencies of the exchange (the dollar and the tôk), followed by “Ex” for exchange. It is pronounced [støkɛks]: the dollar sign is read as an “S”.

Abstract

The \$tôkEx is an algorithm for the continuous exchange of two fungible assets, A and B, without an order book, without counterparty matching, and without fees. It aims at a market that is fair, transparent, and accessible: rather than asking each participant how much to buy or sell at every instant, it asks only what they think the two assets are worth relative to each other and how confident they are in that estimate, and it trades continuously on their behalf, spreading each transaction over time and reacting automatically to the market, so that no constant monitoring is required. Each participant thus declares an estimate of the relative value of the two assets and a degree of certainty in that estimate. The degree of certainty is mapped to a weight through $w = \frac{1}{3} \tan(\pi \theta / 200 \%)$; geometrically, θ is the angle of the participant's response curve at its equilibrium point. Every participant exchanges continuously, at velocities given by a common trader function $f(x) = x^2 - 1/x$ of the ratio between the market price and the participant's estimate; both assets are treated symmetrically and all exchanges occur exactly at the market price. The market price is the unique positive price that simultaneously clears both assets; it has the closed form given in Eq. (9). The whole market is provably indistinguishable from a single participant with an aggregate weight and degree of certainty. The state of the market is piecewise constant between events and is advanced exactly, event by event, by the two algorithms given below, with incremental $O(N \log N)$ updates. Mathematical proofs are provided in the annexes.

Keywords: exchange algorithm, market mechanism, automated market maker (AMM), order book, decentralized exchange, continuous trading, market clearing, equilibrium price, currency exchange, time-weighted execution (TWAP).

Relation to known mechanisms

The \$tôkEx is an automated exchange mechanism, but it differs from the known families of market designs. Unlike the continuous double auction (the order book of stock and cryptocurrency exchanges), it involves no orders, no bids or asks, and no counterparty matching. Unlike the automated market makers (AMM) and constant-function market makers of decentralized exchanges (constant-product pools and their generalizations), it holds no liquidity pool and derives no price from reserves: the price is computed in closed form from the participants' declared estimates and degrees of certainty, and the participants trade with each other, continuously, exactly at that price. The continuous execution spreads each transaction over time, as time-weighted average price (TWAP) execution strategies do on traditional markets, but here the property belongs to the market itself: supply and demand clear exactly at every instant.

1 Notation

α	Symbol for asset A
β	Symbol for asset B
$[\alpha/\beta]$	The value of 1 unit of β priced in α
$[\beta/\alpha]$	The value of 1 unit of α priced in β (note: $[\beta/\alpha] = [\alpha/\beta]^{-1}$)
$\dot{X}^\alpha$	Exchange velocity of asset A (in α / unit of time): the contribution of the exchange to the rate of change of a wallet's balance n^α , positive when the wallet receives asset A
$\dot{X}^\beta$	Exchange velocity of asset B (in β / unit of time), with the same sign convention
n^α	Amount in an account holding asset A (in α)
n^β	Amount in an account holding asset B (in β)
$\square_i$	placeholder for a quantity related to the i^{th} participant (e.g. n_i, w_i)
$\square_\Omega$	placeholder for the corresponding market-level quantity (e.g. n_Ω, W_Ω)

A note on the overdot: in this document it marks a velocity, an amount per unit of time (e.g. $\dot{X}, \dot{R}$), constant between two events of the market. It is not the derivative of a state variable. Actual time derivatives are written explicitly, as in dn_i/dt .

2 Principles of the \$tôkEx Algorithm

The purpose of the algorithm is to set up a market between different participants in which two fungible assets, A and B, can be **continuously** exchanged according to each participant's estimate of the relative value of the two assets.

Four goals shape this market. It should be *fair* (unbiased between participants and between the two assets) and *transparent*: one price, common to all, computed in closed form from the declared inputs, with no privileged order flow. It should be *free of fees*: the exchange conserves the assets exactly and only transfers them between participants, with no intermediary skimming a share. And it should be *accessible*: reaching a good position should not demand watching the market and reacting at every instant. The \$tôkEx meets this last goal by changing the question it asks a participant. A traditional market asks *how much do you want to buy or sell, now?* — a question whose good answer moves with every tick; the \$tôkEx asks instead *what do you think the two assets are worth relative to each other, and how sure are you?* — a standing judgment that the mechanism then trades on continuously, buying more when the market is cheap relative to the estimate and selling more when it is dear.

Wallets. Each participant holds a *wallet*: one account per asset, with balances n^α and n^β . Individual balances evolve continuously through the exchanges of the \$tôkEx (and through the participant's own deposits and withdrawals), but the exchange only moves amounts between wallets: deposits and withdrawals apart, the *sums* $\sum_i n_i^\alpha$ and $\sum_i n_i^\beta$ are constant. Throughout this document, the assets are assumed to have no dynamics of their own; this assumption can be relaxed under certain conditions, such as the continuous demurrage of the tôk in the reference implementation (Sec. 4.4), without touching the exchange itself.

The algorithm obeys eight fundamental principles, which fall into two classes: the *fair-market principles* (1–4), which constrain the market itself, and the *rational-trader principles* (5–8), which specify the behavior of the participants, a behavior implemented for all participants by the same function, called the *trader function*.

Fair-market principles (the market is unbiased):

1. *Equilibrium and conservation.* The market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ is the price at which supply meets demand: at any given time, whatever amount of an asset some participants sell must be bought by others, and vice versa,

$$\sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha = \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\beta = 0.$$

Since $\dot{X}_i$ is precisely the contribution of the exchange to the balance n_i , the same equation is a conservation law: the exchange creates and destroys nothing, it only transfers existing amounts between the participants' wallets.

2. *Exchange at market price.* At any given time there is a single market price, strictly positive and common to all participants, and every exchange takes place exactly at it:

$$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = - \frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{X}_i^\beta} > 0 \quad \text{for every trading participant } i.$$

3. *No bias between participants.* All exchange velocities are given by one common function of the participant's own inputs and of the market state, the same function for every participant:

$$\dot{X}_i^\alpha = F([\alpha/\beta]_\Omega, \theta_i; [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega) \quad \text{for all } i.$$

4. *No bias between assets.* The defining equations are invariant under swapping the two assets:

$$\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta \quad (\text{hence } [\alpha/\beta] \leftrightarrow [\beta/\alpha]).$$

Rational-trader principles (every participant trades rationally). Let $x_i := [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega / [\alpha/\beta]_i$ denote the ratio between the market price and the i^{th} participant's estimate:

5. *Buy low*. When the market prices an asset below the participant's estimate, the participant is willing to buy that asset:

$$x_i < 1 \implies \dot{X}_i^\beta > 0 \text{ (and } \dot{X}_i^\alpha < 0 \text{)}.$$

6. *Sell high*. When the market prices it above the estimate, the participant is willing to sell it:

$$x_i > 1 \implies \dot{X}_i^\beta < 0 \text{ (and } \dot{X}_i^\alpha > 0 \text{)}.$$

At the estimate, they do not trade:

$$x_i = 1 \implies \dot{X}_i^\alpha = \dot{X}_i^\beta = 0.$$

7. *Urgency grows with the gap*. The exchange velocity increases strictly with the distance between market price and estimate:

$$\dot{X}_i^\alpha \text{ is strictly increasing in } x_i \text{ (and } \dot{X}_i^\beta \text{ strictly decreasing)},$$

so that $|\dot{X}_i^\alpha|$ and $|\dot{X}_i^\beta|$ grow as x_i moves away from 1 in either direction.

8. *Urgency grows with certainty*. A participant's exchange velocities scale with a weight w_i that increases strictly with their degree of certainty θ_i :

$$\dot{X}_i \propto w_i = w(\theta_i), \quad w \text{ strictly increasing in } \theta_i.$$

No conviction, no trade: $w(0) = 0$.

These eight principles are the *hypotheses* of the \$t\sigma kEx: everything that follows is constructed to satisfy them. The trader function (2) realizes principles 5–8, the symmetric velocity pair (1) realizes principles 2–4, and the market price (9) realizes principle 1.

3 Core Equations of the \$tôkEx Algorithm

Exchanges on the \$tôkEx are continuous, instead of discrete in time like on traditional markets. For example, rather than buying 5 units of β in exchange for 10 units of α at some instant t on a traditional market (which implies a market price of 2 α per β), the same exchange on the \$tôkEx could happen by continuously buying units of β (at the market price of 2 α per β) with a velocity of 1 β per hour for 5 hours.

On the participant level, the advantage of a continuous exchange is that, by spreading their transaction over a longer period of time, they reduce the risk of making their transaction at a bad time. As we will show, the \$tôkEx allows the participant to automatically either buy or sell more (i.e. at a higher velocity) when the market price is more advantageous for them.

At the market level, the advantage of a continuous exchange is that the market price would be more stable since every participant is automatically reacting to any change in the market price by increasing or decreasing their exchange velocities.

3.1 Participant's exchange velocities

Every participant in the \$tôkEx has their exchange velocities determined by the same function. In that sense, the \$tôkEx is not biased towards a participant or another and therefore fulfills principle number 3 mentioned earlier.

This function requires two inputs from the participant:

- $[\alpha/\beta]_i$ i^{th} participant's estimate of the value of 1 unit of β priced in α
- θ_i i^{th} participant's degree of certainty ($[0, 100]$ %) in their estimate of the relative value of the two assets.

The function controlling the participant's exchange velocities in the \$tôkEx takes the following form:

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{X}_i^\alpha &= w(\theta_i) f\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i}\right) \dot{R}, \\ \dot{X}_i^\beta &= w(\theta_i) f\left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i}\right) \dot{R} [\beta/\alpha]_i,\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

where $\dot{R}$ is the reference exchange velocity (in α / unit of time) for this particular exchange. The algorithm requires that a reference exchange velocity, constant and common to all participants, be defined for one of the two assets. For example, in a market where gold is exchanged for dollars, the reference exchange velocity could be set to 1 dollar per hour or 1 ounce of gold per day or whatever reference velocity makes sense in the context of that particular market.

By convention, the reference exchange velocity $\dot{R}$ is defined in terms of asset A. The corresponding reference exchange velocity for asset B is $\dot{R} [\beta/\alpha]_i$ in the eyes of the i^{th} participant. Apart from this difference, the two equations in (1) are perfectly symmetric in the sense that they are the same except that α is swapped with β . This property ensures that the market is not biased towards one asset or the other. Therefore, the form of the function controlling a participant's exchange velocities satisfies principle number 4.

Next, we need to specify the functions w and f that compose the exchange velocities function. Let us first define the *trader function* f . This function describes the general behavior of a participant depending on the ratio between the market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ and their estimate of the value of $[\alpha/\beta]$. This general behavior follows principles number 5, 6 and 7. The \$tôkEx satisfies these principles by defining the trader function, for any price ratio $x > 0$, as

$$f(x) = x^2 - \frac{1}{x}.\tag{2}$$

This choice is principled but not arbitrary. As shown in Annex 7.1, principles 2 and 4 by themselves force two structural properties of any admissible trader function: the functional equation $f(1/x) = -f(x)/x$, and hence $f(1) = 0$ (no trade at one's own estimate). The functions compatible with all eight principles and

with a closed-form market price form a one-parameter family, of which (2) is the minimal member with unbounded urgency on both the buying and the selling side; the whole family is described in Annex 7.1 and is part of the present disclosure.

Each participant evaluates it at the ratio between the market price and their own estimate:

$$\begin{aligned} f_i^\alpha &:= f\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i}\right) = \left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i}\right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}, \\ f_i^\beta &:= f\left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i}\right) = \left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i}\right)^2 - \frac{[\beta/\alpha]_i}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}. \end{aligned} \quad (3)$$

Second, we define the function w that serves as a weighting factor for each participant in the \$t\text{\textcircled{a}}kEx. It maps a participant's degree of certainty $[0, 100)\%$ onto $[0, +\infty)$, such that

$$w_i := w(\theta_i) = \frac{1}{3} \tan\left(\frac{\pi \theta_i}{200\%}\right). \quad (4)$$

The function w is consistent with principle number 8 since it scales the participant's exchange velocities according to their degree of certainty (we show in Annex 7.2 that θ_i can be interpreted as a geometrical angle in the right context).

Thus, the exact expressions for the exchange velocities of the i^{th} participant are

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{X}_i^\alpha &= w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} \right) \dot{R}, \\ \dot{X}_i^\beta &= w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\beta/\alpha]_i}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega} \right) \dot{R} [\beta/\alpha]_i. \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

In Fig. 1, we can see that, expressed in the same units of $\dot{R}$, the two curves are mirror images of one another (unbiased toward one asset or the other) and that they allow each participant to automatically “buy low and sell high” according to their estimate of the relative value of assets A and B.

In Annex 7.3, we prove that the expressions in (5) are consistent with principle number 2, which states that every participant buys and sells at market price. Formally, this means that

$$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = -\frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{X}_i^\beta}. \quad (6)$$

Indeed, if a participant is buying asset A and paying with asset B, the two exchange velocities must be of opposite sign and the proportionality constant between the two is the market price. In Sec. 3.3, we will determine the expression to compute the market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$.

3.2 Time it takes to empty a participant's account

With the participant's exchange velocities, we can predict when their account balance is going to reach zero. The account that will eventually be empty is the account holding the asset that the participant is selling (i.e. the account holding the asset for which $\dot{X}_i < 0$); a participant who is not selling ($\dot{X}_i \geq 0$) never empties an account, $\Delta t_i = +\infty$. As long as the state of the market is constant, the balance decreases linearly and reaches zero after

$$\Delta t_i = -\frac{n_i}{\dot{X}_i}. \quad (7)$$

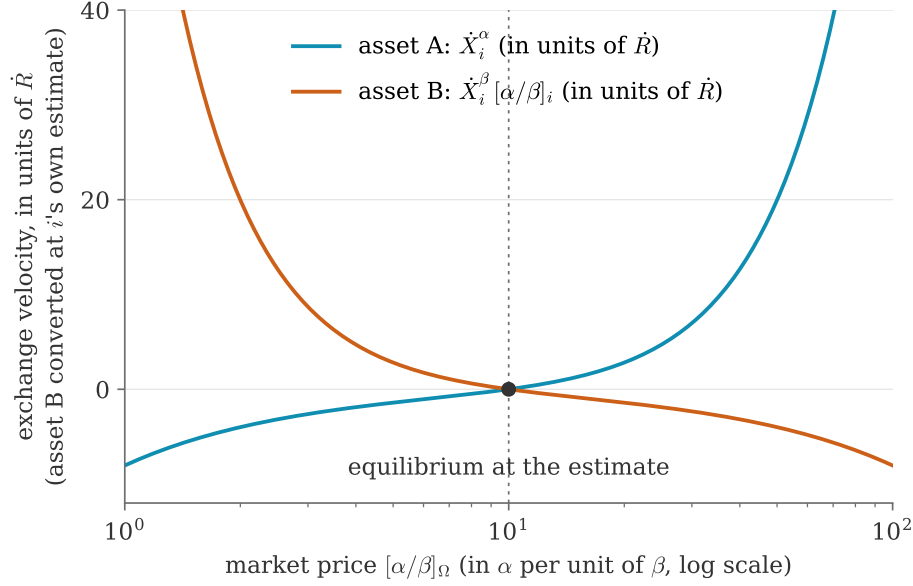


Figure 1: i^{th} participant's exchange velocities for an estimate of $[\alpha/\beta]_i = 10$ α per β with a degree of certainty $\theta_i = 75\%$. To compare both exchange velocities on a single axis, asset B's velocity is converted to its α -equivalent using the participant's own estimate, $\dot{X}_i^\beta [\alpha/\beta]_i$ — the fair conversion factor according to the i^{th} participant, not the (generally different) market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$.

3.3 Market price

As stated in principle number 1, the market price is the relative asset value that leads to an equilibrium between supply and demand. Formally, this means that the market price must satisfy

$$\sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha = \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\beta = 0. \quad (8)$$

Indeed, at any given time and for both assets, the total amount being sold by some participants must be bought by some others: the \$t\text{o}k\text{Ex}\$ creates and destroys nothing, it only transfers.

Since the behavior of each participant is set in a rational way by (5) and entirely defined by their two inputs $[\alpha/\beta]_i$ and θ_i , we find (see proof in Annex 7.4) that the expression for the market price is

$$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = \left(\frac{\sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i}{\sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2} \right)^{1/3}. \quad (9)$$

In this expression, the sum over the participants only includes those who are actually able to trade (i.e. they have the asset they wish to sell).

Let us note that this equilibrium price is *unique*: by principle 7, each participant's exchange velocity is strictly increasing in the market price, hence so is the net exchange velocity $\sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha$, so it can vanish at only one strictly positive price, the one given by (9). The precise conditions and the proof are given in Annex 7.5.

4 Implementation of the \$t\hat{o}kEx Algorithm

The equations of the \$t\hat{o}kEx that were developed in the previous section are valid as long as both inputs from all participants remain constant and as long as each participant has a positive balance in the account holding the asset they are selling. Of course, at some point in time, these conditions are bound to change. Therefore, the \$t\hat{o}kEx operates in steps during which the state of the market remains constant (i.e. constant market price and constant exchange velocities).

In general, we know the balance of every account at t_0 and we want to know their balance at t_1 , when a participant requests an action. The actions available to the participant are:

1. check the market price,
2. check their account balance,
3. deposit/withdraw an amount,
4. change their estimate or degree of certainty.

Between t_0 and t_1 , both inputs from all participants are constant. However, we must automatically handle the cases when one of the participants runs out of the asset they are selling between t_0 and t_1 . Each time this happens, the state of the market must be updated.

Thus, the \$t\hat{o}kEx is implemented in two parts. First we describe the inner algorithm responsible for outputting the current state of the market. Second we describe the outer algorithm that performs the time stepping to get from t_0 to t_1 . This process is illustrated in Fig. 2.

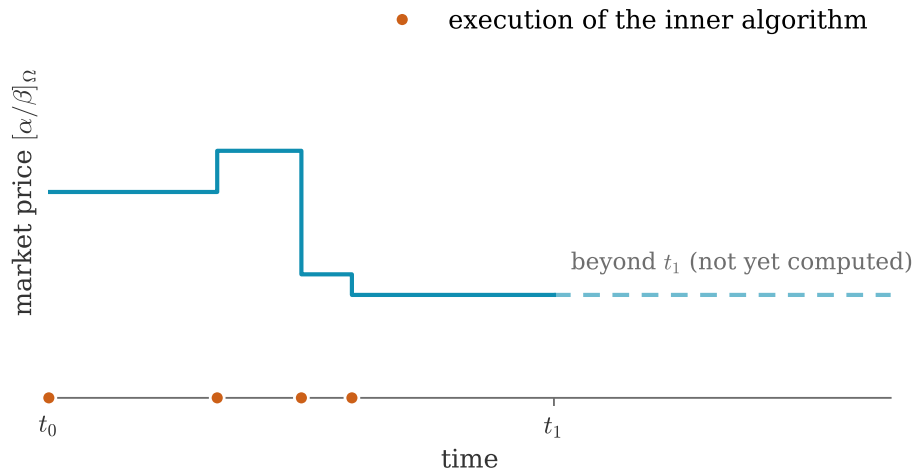


Figure 2: Process by which the state of the \$t\hat{o}kEx is updated between t_0 and t_1 .

4.1 Inner \$t\hat{o}kEx Algorithm

The purpose of the inner algorithm is to return the market price and participants' exchange velocities at the current time t . The inner algorithm takes into account that some participants might have run out of the asset they wish to sell. These participants must therefore be excluded from the market since their estimate is irrelevant. By excluded from the market, we mean that both their exchange velocities are zero and that their input parameters are not taken into account for the computation of the market price.

When a participant runs out of the asset they are selling, they are automatically excluded from the market. On the other hand, when the excluded participants are in a situation where they can participate again, they are also automatically reintegrated in the market.

4.1.1 Inputs

Each participant in the market must provide the following information:

- $[\alpha/\beta]_i$ i^{th} participant's estimate of the value of 1 unit of β priced in α
- θ_i i^{th} participant's degree of certainty ($[0, 100)$ %) in their estimate of the relative value of the two assets.

In addition, we must provide to the algorithm the balance for both accounts of every participant at the current time t :

- n_i^α i^{th} participant's balance of asset A (in α)
- n_i^β i^{th} participant's balance of asset B (in β)

4.1.2 Outputs

From the above inputs, the algorithm calculates and returns the following information:

- $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ The market value of 1 unit of β priced in α
- $\dot{X}_i^\alpha$ the i^{th} participant's exchange velocity of asset A (in α per unit of time)
- $\dot{X}_i^\beta$ the i^{th} participant's exchange velocity of asset B (in β per unit of time)
- Δt_i the amount of time after which the i^{th} participant runs out of the asset they are selling

4.1.3 Plain description of the inner \$t\hat{o}kEx algorithm

- Exclude every participant that has at least one empty account from the market and add them to a checklist. (lines 3-10)
- Compute the market price using (9). (line 11)
- For each participant that has been excluded, check if they have a positive balance in the account holding the asset they wish to sell. If so, reintegrate them in the market and compute the new market price using (9). Once a participant has been checked, remove them from the checklist. Repeat this process until no participant is left on the checklist. Since reintegrating a participant in the market changes the market price, we have to be careful with the order in which we cross off the participants from the checklist. To ensure that this process is done properly, it can be shown that we must always check the participant whose value estimate is the “furthest” away from the market price, our metric for the distance being $|f_i^\alpha|$, computed using (3). To find that participant efficiently, the checklist is first *sorted* by estimate. For any given price, since f is monotone in the estimate, the largest $|f_i^\alpha|$ is always attained at one of the two ends of the sorted checklist, so each step examines two participants only. Each reintegration then updates the market price in $O(1)$: the participant's terms are added to the two market sums of (9) and the price is recomputed from them (the same incremental bookkeeping as the market update of Sec. 5.3). (lines 12-21)

- For each participant, compute their exchange velocities, using (5), and the time it will take to empty the account for the asset they are selling, using (7). (lines 22-36)

4.1.4 Pseudocode for the inner \$t\acute{o}kEx\$ algorithm

```

1: given the account balance  $n_i^\alpha$  and  $n_i^\beta$  for every participant
2: given the inputs  $[\alpha/\beta]_i$  and  $\theta_i$  for every participant
3: for all participants do
4:   if  $n_i^\alpha = 0$  or  $n_i^\beta = 0$  then
5:     exclude  $i^{\text{th}}$  participant from the market
6:     add  $i^{\text{th}}$  participant to checklist
7:   else
8:     include  $i^{\text{th}}$  participant in the market
9:   end if
10: end for
11: compute  $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ 
12: sort the checklist by increasing estimate  $[\alpha/\beta]_i$ 
13: while checklist is not empty do
14:   compute  $f^\alpha$  at both ends of the checklist
15:    $i^* \leftarrow$  the end with the largest  $|f^\alpha|$ 
16:   if  $(f_{i^*}^\alpha \geq 0 \text{ and } n_{i^*}^\beta > 0)$  or  $(f_{i^*}^\alpha \leq 0 \text{ and } n_{i^*}^\alpha > 0)$  then
17:     include  $i^{*\text{th}}$  participant in the market
18:     update  $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$  incrementally
19:   end if
20:   remove  $i^{*\text{th}}$  participant from checklist
21: end while
22: for all participants do
23:   if  $i^{\text{th}}$  participant is included in the market then
24:     compute  $\dot{X}_i^\alpha$  and  $\dot{X}_i^\beta$ 
25:   else
26:      $\dot{X}_i^\alpha \leftarrow 0$  and  $\dot{X}_i^\beta \leftarrow 0$ 
27:   end if
28:   if  $\dot{X}_i^\alpha < 0$  then
29:      $\Delta t_i \leftarrow -n_i^\alpha / \dot{X}_i^\alpha$ 
30:   else if  $\dot{X}_i^\beta < 0$  then
31:      $\Delta t_i \leftarrow -n_i^\beta / \dot{X}_i^\beta$ 
32:   else
33:      $\Delta t_i \leftarrow +\infty$ 
34:   end if
35: end for
36: return  $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ ,  $\dot{X}_i^\alpha$ ,  $\dot{X}_i^\beta$  and  $\Delta t_i$ 

```

Complexity. The exclusion pass, the from-scratch market price and the final velocity computation are all $O(N)$; the checklist sort is $O(N \log N)$; each reintegration step costs $O(1)$ thanks to the incremental update of the two market sums. The inner \$t\acute{o}kEx\$ algorithm therefore runs in $O(N \log N)$ overall.

4.2 Outer \$t\hat{o}kEx\$ Algorithm

The outer algorithm performs the necessary time steps to get from t_0 to t_1 . If a participant runs out of the asset they are selling during that time interval, the outer algorithm steps up to that instant to update the state of the market. This process repeats until t_1 is reached.

4.2.1 Inputs

t_0 Initial time
 t_1 Final time

Each participant in the market must provide the following information:

$[\alpha/\beta]_i$ i^{th} participant's estimate of the value of 1 unit of β priced in α
 θ_i i^{th} participant's degree of certainty ($[0, 100)$ %) in their estimate of the relative value of the two assets.

In addition, we must provide to the algorithm the balance for both accounts of every participant at the initial time t_0 :

n_i^α i^{th} participant's balance of asset A (in α)
 n_i^β i^{th} participant's balance of asset B (in β)

4.2.2 Outputs

From the above inputs, the algorithm calculates and returns the market price and the balance for both accounts of every participant at t_1 :

$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ The market value of 1 unit of β priced in α
 n_i^α i^{th} participant's balance of asset A (in α)
 n_i^β i^{th} participant's balance of asset B (in β)

4.2.3 Pseudocode for the outer \$t\hat{o}kEx\$ algorithm

```

1: given an initial time  $t_0$ 
2: given a final time  $t_1$ 
3: given the account balances  $n_i^\alpha$  and  $n_i^\beta$  for every participant (at  $t_0$ )
4: given the inputs  $[\alpha/\beta]_i$  and  $\theta_i$  for every participant (constant between  $t_0$  and  $t_1$ )
5:  $t \leftarrow t_0$ 
6: execute inner $t\hat{o}kEx$ algorithm
7:  $\Delta t \leftarrow \min_i \Delta t_i$ 
8: while  $t_1 - t \geq \Delta t$  do
9:   for all participants do
10:     $n_i^\alpha \leftarrow n_i^\alpha + \dot{X}_i^\alpha \Delta t$ 
11:     $n_i^\beta \leftarrow n_i^\beta + \dot{X}_i^\beta \Delta t$ 
12:   end for
13:    $t \leftarrow t + \Delta t$ 
14:   execute inner $t\hat{o}kEx$ algorithm
15:    $\Delta t \leftarrow \min_i \Delta t_i$ 
16: end while
17:  $\Delta t \leftarrow t_1 - t$ 
18: for all participants do
19:    $n_i^\alpha \leftarrow n_i^\alpha + \dot{X}_i^\alpha \Delta t$ 
20:    $n_i^\beta \leftarrow n_i^\beta + \dot{X}_i^\beta \Delta t$ 
21: end for
22: return  $n_i^\alpha$ ,  $n_i^\beta$  and  $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$  (at  $t_1$ )

```

4.3 Numerical evaluation of the trader function

The typical operating point of the \$t\hat{o}kEx is $x \approx 1$: participants' estimates hover around the market price. Precisely there, the defining expression $f(x) = x^2 - 1/x$ suffers *catastrophic cancellation* in floating-point arithmetic: both terms are close to 1, and their subtraction erases up to half of the significand. Measured against exact rational arithmetic (IEEE-754 double precision), the relative error of the standard form reaches 4×10^{-2} at $x = 1 - 10^{-15}$.

The remedy is the *shifted form*. Let $y = x - 1$; for $x \in [1/2, 2]$ this subtraction is exact in floating point (Sterbenz's lemma), and $x^3 - 1 = y^3 + 3y^2 + 3y$, so that

$$f(x) = \frac{y(y^2 + 3y + 3)}{x}, \quad y = x - 1. \quad (10)$$

The numerator tracks the small deviation y directly, without cancellation, and the denominator must be the *input* x itself: recomputing it as $y + 1$ reintroduces a relative error that grows toward the ends of the domain, up to $\sim 10^{-5}$ at $x = 10^{-12}$. The expression is branchless and constant-time (a straight line of fused multiply-adds, no conditional jumps), and its measured relative error stays below 6×10^{-16} (machine precision) over the whole admissible domain of the ratio, $[10^{-12}, 10^{12}]$. This domain is wider than the price bounds of the reference implementation: estimates are bounded to $[10^{-6}, 10^6]$ and the market price always lies between the smallest and the largest estimate (see the corollary in Annex 7.5), so the *ratio* of the two spans up to twelve decades on each side of 1.

4.4 Reference implementation in the t\hat{o}k system

In the t\hat{o}k system, the \$t\hat{o}kEx is instantiated with α = the t\hat{o}k (a universal-income-based currency with continuous exponential demurrage) and β = a foreign currency (CAD, EUR, ...), with one market per foreign currency. The reference implementation uses the following parameters: the reference exchange velocity $\dot{R}$ is set to the universal income rate of the t\hat{o}k system (1 t\hat{o}k per 15 days); estimates are bounded to $10^{-6} \leq [\alpha/\beta]_i \leq 10^6$; degrees of certainty are discretized with a step of 10^{-4} % and capped at 99.9999 %; the default market price of an empty market is 1.

Each participant holds a dedicated pair of market accounts (one per asset) with the same owner, and solvency is handled by per-asset tolerance thresholds. Market sums are computed with compensated (Kahan [1]) summation in extended precision, updates are incremental, in $O(N \log N)$ overall (the solvency checklist is processed in sorted order of the estimates, the participant farthest from the market price always lying at one of its two ends), and the trader function is evaluated in the shifted form (10) of Sec. 4.3.

The t\hat{o}k is also the one relaxation of the regular-asset assumption: it carries a continuous demurrage at rate k , acting on the balances independently of the exchange velocities (consistently with principle 1: the \$t\hat{o}kEx itself only transfers). Between two events, t\hat{o}k balances obey $dn_i/dt = \dot{X}_i - k n_i$; the balance updates of the outer algorithm use the closed-form exponential solution, and the emptying time of a t\hat{o}k account becomes $\frac{1}{k} \ln \left(1 - k n_i / \dot{X}_i \right)$, a strictly increasing function of (7).

Since k is the same for every t\hat{o}k account (a single demurrage rate applies to the whole t\hat{o}k asset), this transform is monotonic within that homogeneous group, and (7) can therefore be minimized before it is applied: the implementation tracks the linear (7) for every account, takes the minimum *separately* among the t\hat{o}k-selling accounts and among the accounts selling the foreign currency (which carries no demurrage and needs no transform), applies the logarithm once, to the former minimum only, in the numerically stable log1p form, and compares the two resulting candidates. The event-driven structure of the two algorithms is unchanged and the stepping remains exact.

5 Market analysis

In this section we build some additional mathematical tools that may provide helpful insights into a market that uses the \$t\acute{o}kEx algorithm. Among other things, the information about the market provided by these tools may help some participants to make their estimation.

5.1 Market behavior

We define the market behavior as the sum of the behavior of all its participants, such that

$$\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha = \sum_i w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R}, \quad (11)$$

where $[\alpha/\beta]_z$ is a *probe price*: an arbitrary strictly positive price, distinct in general from the market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$, at which we choose to evaluate the aggregate response of the market. If $[\alpha/\beta]_z = [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ then the market is in equilibrium (by definition of $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$) and $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha = 0$. However, if a random new participant was added to the market, we know that the market price would change. The market behavior allows us to know how the “old” market will react, or in other words at what velocity it will exchange with the new participant. Indeed, given the new participant’s inputs, we can calculate the new market price using (9), which gives us $[\alpha/\beta]_z$ that allows us to calculate the market behavior $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha$ we just defined.

5.2 Total market weight

In Annex 7.6, we demonstrate that the market behavior defined in (11) can be written as

$$\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha = W_\Omega \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R}, \quad (12)$$

where W_Ω is the total market weight, given by

$$W_\Omega = [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i. \quad (13)$$

Using the expression (9) for the market price, we can also write the total market weight in a second form that may be useful in certain situations

$$W_\Omega = [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^2 \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2. \quad (14)$$

Consequently, we can define the total market degree of certainty (using the inverse of the weighting factor function (4)) as

$$\Theta_\Omega = \frac{200\%}{\pi} \arctan(3 W_\Omega). \quad (15)$$

In the form of (12), we can clearly see the similarity between the market behavior and that of a single participant (see (5)). This means that the whole market can be thought of as a single participant. Indeed, from the point of view of a new participant entering the market, it is not possible to distinguish if the exchange is taking place with a diverse collection of participants with various estimates ($[\alpha/\beta]_i, \theta_i$) or a single participant with estimate ($[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega, \Theta_\Omega$).

An important takeaway from this analysis is that the total market weight W_Ω can serve as a useful index that indicates the “stiffness” of the market. A market with a large W_Ω will resist more strongly to a change in market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$. Moreover, we can see from (13) that the market weight increases with each new participant to the market (unless, of course, the old participants decide to change their estimate). This suggests that a market with a large number of participants using the \$t\acute{o}kEx algorithm would have a relatively stable market price.

5.3 Market update

Let's say we have a market Ω with a certain participant j whose initial estimate is $([\alpha/\beta]_{j_1}, \theta_{j_1})$. Given that estimate, and that of the other participants, we can evaluate the initial market price $[\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega_1}$ using (9) and the initial total market weight W_{Ω_1} using (13).

If the j^{th} participant changes their estimate to $([\alpha/\beta]_{j_2}, \theta_{j_2})$, then the new market price will be

$$[\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega_2} = \left(\frac{W_{\Omega_1} [\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega_1} - w_{j_1} [\alpha/\beta]_{j_1} + w_{j_2} [\alpha/\beta]_{j_2}}{W_{\Omega_1} [\beta/\alpha]_{\Omega_1}^2 - w_{j_1} [\beta/\alpha]_{j_1}^2 + w_{j_2} [\beta/\alpha]_{j_2}^2} \right)^{1/3}, \quad (16)$$

and the new total market weight will be

$$W_{\Omega_2} = [\beta/\alpha]_{\Omega_2} \left(W_{\Omega_1} [\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega_1} - w_{j_1} [\alpha/\beta]_{j_1} + w_{j_2} [\alpha/\beta]_{j_2} \right). \quad (17)$$

5.4 Average participant estimate

From the total market weight, we can simply derive the average participant weight as

$$w_{\Omega} = \frac{W_{\Omega}}{N_{\Omega}}, \quad (18)$$

where N_{Ω} is the number of participants included in the market, and the average participant degree of certainty as

$$\theta_{\Omega} = \frac{200\%}{\pi} \arctan(3 w_{\Omega}). \quad (19)$$

This result, combined with the fact that we can aggregate a group of participants and treat it as a single participant using (12), can be very useful if we want to compare the average behavior of different sub groups of participants (assuming that we have extra data about them). For instance, in the case of an international market we would be able to tell how the average participant of a certain country perceives the value of an asset compared to the average participant of another country.

5.5 Analogous variance of the participants' estimate

By rewriting (13) as

$$[\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega} = \sum_i \frac{w_i}{W_{\Omega}} [\alpha/\beta]_i, \quad (20)$$

we get an expression that makes the market value appear as a weighted average in a statistical sense.

Following this analogy, we derive in Annex 7.7 a quantity that we call the analogous variance of the participants' estimate, which we define as

$$\sigma_{[\alpha/\beta]}^2 = \frac{1}{W_{\Omega}} \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i^2 - [\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega}^2. \quad (21)$$

By taking the square root, we get the analogous standard deviation of the participants' estimate

$$\sigma_{[\alpha/\beta]} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{W_{\Omega}} \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i^2 - [\alpha/\beta]_{\Omega}^2}. \quad (22)$$

In order to derive this result, we had to imply that, in some sense, w_i/W_{Ω} corresponds to the probability that a participant estimates the price of $[\alpha/\beta]$ at $[\alpha/\beta]_i$ in a context where each participant has the same weight. Since this is not actually the case in the context of the StokEx, we must be careful with the use of the analogous variance and the analogous standard deviation. Nonetheless, these quantities can offer a useful insight into the distribution of the participants' estimates, while giving more weight to the most important participants.

6 Conclusion

Starting from two sets of assumptions — four *fair-market* principles (conservation, a single strictly positive price common to all, and no bias between participants or between the two assets) and four *rational-trader* principles (buy low, sell high, and trade the more urgently the wider the gap and the firmer the conviction) — we were led to a mathematical framework for the continuous exchange of two fungible assets. The principles act as hypotheses that fix the shape of everything that follows: a trader function (here $f(x) = x^2 - 1/x$), a symmetric pair of exchange velocities, and a market price in closed form (Eq. (9)), unique and clearing both assets at every instant.

The framework has properties worth stating plainly. It is fair and transparent by construction, and *fee-free*: the exchange conserves the assets and only transfers them, with no intermediary to pay. It is *accessible* — instead of asking how much to buy or sell at each instant, it asks what a participant thinks the two assets are worth relative to each other and how sure they are, a judgment they can set once and leave in place while the mechanism trades on it continuously, so that a good position needs no constant monitoring. Finally, the whole market is provably indistinguishable from a single aggregate participant (Annex 7.6), and its state advances exactly, event by event, in $O(N \log N)$. The central results are machine-checked in Lean 4 / mathlib; the StokEx, together with the whole admissible family of trader functions (Annex 7.1), is disclosed here as prior art.

7 Annexes: Mathematical Proofs

[À COMPLÉTER au push — ne pas soumettre tel quel] Les résultats centraux de ces annexes (pente $f'(1) = 3$, échange au prix de marché, équilibre du marché, agrégation en un participant unique, unicité du prix) sont formalisés et vérifiés par machine en Lean 4 / mathlib (Lean et mathlib v4.32.0). Insérer ici l'URL figée au tag `stokex-defpub-2026-07` : <https://github.com/MaximeTousignant/miluRepo/tree/stokex-defpub-2026-07/docs/stokex/proof>

7.1 The family of admissible trader functions

The \$tôkEx defines its trader function as $f(x) = x^2 - 1/x$. This annex makes precise which part of that choice is forced by the principles and which part is a design decision, and it discloses the whole family of admissible alternatives.

What the principles force. Let f be any candidate trader function, used symmetrically by both assets as in (1), and write $x = [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega / [\alpha/\beta]_i$. The two exchange velocities of the i^{th} participant are then $\dot{X}_i^\alpha = w_i f(x) \dot{R}$ and $\dot{X}_i^\beta = w_i f(1/x) \dot{R} [\beta/\alpha]_i$. Principle 2 requires $-\dot{X}_i^\alpha / \dot{X}_i^\beta = [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = x [\alpha/\beta]_i$ for every market state, which simplifies to the functional equation

$$f(1/x) = -\frac{f(x)}{x} \quad \text{for all } x > 0. \quad (23)$$

At $x = 1$, (23) gives $f(1) = -f(1)$, hence $f(1) = 0$: not trading at one's own estimate is not an extra hypothesis, it is a consequence of exchanging two symmetric assets at a single market price. The equation also determines f on $(0, 1)$ from its values on $(1, \infty)$: the selling behavior is the reflection of the buying behavior. Concretely, in absolute value, a participant facing a market at twice their estimate behaves exactly as one facing half of it, with the roles of the two assets exchanged (each velocity counted in the reference unit of its own asset); this mirror symmetry is shared by every admissible trader function, and is the one visible in Fig. 1.

The closed-form family. Consider the power pairs

$$f_p(x) = x^p - x^q, \quad q = 1 - p, \quad p \geq 1. \quad (24)$$

Every member satisfies (23), since $q - 1 = -p$ and $p - 1 = -q$. For $p \geq 1$ the member is strictly increasing on $(0, \infty)$, with $f'_p(x) = p x^{p-1} + (p - 1) x^{-p} > 0$, and therefore satisfies principles 5 to 8 (for $1/2 < p < 1$ monotonicity fails near 0, and $p = 1/2$ gives the zero function). Replacing f by f_p in (1) and solving the equilibrium condition (8) yields the market price in closed form,

$$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = \left(\frac{\sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i^{p-1}}{\sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^p} \right)^{1/(2p-1)}, \quad (25)$$

and the slope at the equilibrium point is $f'_p(1) = 2p - 1$, so that the degree-of-certainty map of the member reads $w = \frac{1}{2p-1} \tan(\pi \theta / 200 \%)$. All the results of this document (uniqueness of the price, aggregation of the market into a single participant, the two algorithms) carry over member by member. More generally, any combination $\sum_p c_p f_p$ with nonnegative coefficients satisfies (23) and the principles, though the closed form (25) is then lost.

What singles out $p = 2$. The first member, $f_1(x) = x - 1$, has a bounded selling side: $f_1(x) > -1$ for all $x > 0$, so a participant's urgency would saturate at $w_i \dot{R}$ no matter how far the market price drops below their estimate. For every $p > 1$, both sides are unbounded: $f_p \rightarrow +\infty$ as $x \rightarrow \infty$ and $f_p \rightarrow -\infty$ as $x \rightarrow 0^+$. Among the members with integer exponents (Laurent polynomials), the smallest one with unbounded urgency on both sides is therefore $p = 2$:

$$f_2(x) = x^2 - \frac{1}{x},$$

the trader function (2) of the \$t\text{okEx}\$, whose slope $2p - 1 = 3$ is the factor of (4).

Disclosure. The whole family (24), together with the corresponding market price (25) and degree-of-certainty map, is part of the present disclosure: an exchange mechanism obtained by substituting any member f_p (or any nonnegative combination of members) for the trader function of the \$t\text{okEx}\$ is anticipated by this document.

7.2 Proof that the participant's degree of certainty corresponds to a geometrical angle

In Fig. 3 we plot a participant's exchange velocity for asset A on a 2-D graph with normalized axes, such that

$$x = \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \text{ and } y = \frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{R}}.$$

Given our normalized quantities x and y , the expression for the exchange velocity becomes

$$y = w_i \left(x^2 - \frac{1}{x} \right)$$

In Fig. 3, we define θ_i as being the angle between the horizontal axis $y = 0$ and the slope of the exchange at the point where they cross. Geometrically, this corresponds to

$$\tan(\theta_i) = \left. \frac{dy}{dx} \right|_{y=0} = 3w_i$$

Thus, the relation between θ_i and w_i is

$$w_i = \frac{1}{3} \tan(\theta_i).$$

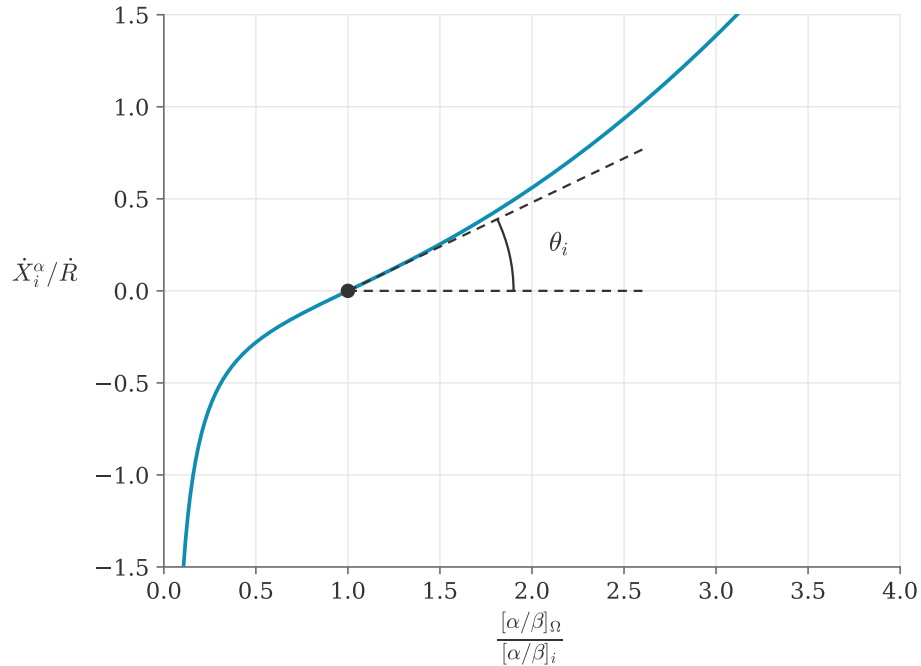


Figure 3: Geometrical interpretation of the participant's degree of certainty θ_i

The same argument holds true if we want to plot a participant's exchange velocity using a logarithmic scale in x (see Fig. 4). In that case, the normalized axes are

$$x = \ln\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i}\right) \quad \text{and} \quad y = \frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{R}},$$

and the expression for the exchange velocity becomes

$$y = w_i (\exp(2x) - \exp(-x)) .$$

Again, we find that

$$\tan(\theta_i) = \left. \frac{dy}{dx} \right|_{y=0} = 3w_i ,$$

which leads to the relation between θ_i and w_i that we were looking for

$$w_i = \frac{1}{3} \tan(\theta_i) .$$

Let us note that the last expression assumes that the angle θ_i is in radians and contained between 0 and $\pi/2$. To get the expression (4), we linearly map $[0, \pi/2)$ to $[0, 100)\%$. This leads to

$$w_i = \frac{1}{3} \tan\left(\frac{\pi \theta_i}{200\%}\right) ,$$

in which θ_i is the participant's "degree of certainty" contained between 0% and 100%.

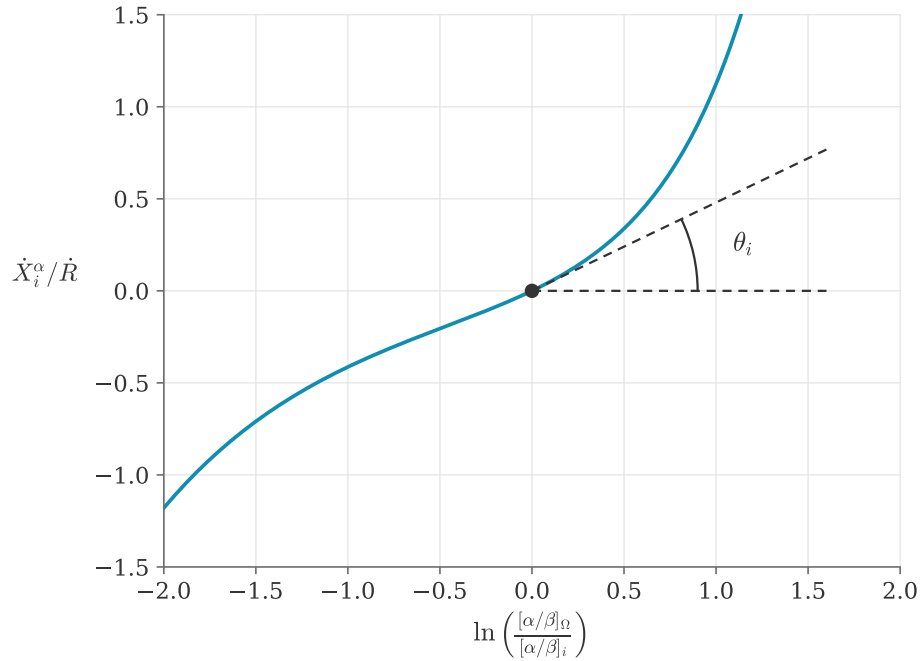


Figure 4: Geometrical interpretation of the participant's degree of certainty θ_i (logarithmic scale in x)

7.3 Proof that the exchange velocities function implies an exchange at market price

We want to show that the expressions for a participant's exchange velocities defined in (5) automatically satisfy the principle (6).

By constructing the right side of (6), using the expressions in (5), we get

$$\begin{aligned}
 -\frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{X}_i^\beta} &= -\frac{w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} \right) \dot{R}}{w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\beta/\alpha]_i}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega} \right) \dot{R} [\beta/\alpha]_i} \\
 &= \frac{\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} - \left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2}{\left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\beta/\alpha]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\beta/\alpha]_i}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}} [\alpha/\beta]_i \\
 &= \frac{\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i^3 - [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^3}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega [\alpha/\beta]_i^2}}{\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 - [\beta/\alpha]_i^3}{[\beta/\alpha]_i^2 [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}} [\alpha/\beta]_i \\
 &= \left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i^3 - [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^3}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 - [\beta/\alpha]_i^3} \right) \left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_i^2 [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega [\alpha/\beta]_i^2} \right) [\alpha/\beta]_i \\
 &= \left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i^3 - [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^3}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 - [\beta/\alpha]_i^3} \right) ([\beta/\alpha]_i^3 [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3) [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega \\
 &= \left(\frac{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 - [\beta/\alpha]_i^3}{[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 - [\beta/\alpha]_i^3} \right) [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega \\
 &= [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega .
 \end{aligned}$$

Q.E.D.

7.4 Proof that the expression for the market price corresponds to the equilibrium between supply and demand

By making the hypothesis that (8) holds for asset A and by applying principle number 2, stating that the market price is the same for every participant at any given time and that the market price is strictly positive, we can derive expression (9) as such:

$$\begin{aligned}
 0 &= \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha \\
 0 &= \sum_i w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} \right) \dot{R} \\
 0 &= \sum_i w_i \left([\beta/\alpha]_i^2 - [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 [\alpha/\beta]_i \right) [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^2 \dot{R} \\
 0 &= \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2 - [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i \\
 [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega &= \left(\frac{\sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i}{\sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2} \right)^{1/3} .
 \end{aligned}$$

Q.E.D.

Since we have already proven that

$$\sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha = 0 \text{ and that } [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = -\frac{\dot{X}_i^\alpha}{\dot{X}_i^\beta},$$

we can quickly show that the exchanges of asset B also satisfy (8) in the following manner

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\beta &= -[\beta/\alpha]_\Omega \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\alpha \\ \sum_i \dot{X}_i^\beta &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Q.E.D.

7.5 Proof that the market price is unique

Annex 7.4 is conditional: it shows that *if* an equilibrium price exists, it must be (9). This annex closes the argument by showing that exactly one equilibrium price always exists, so that the market price of principle 1 is well defined and the inner algorithm is deterministic.

Conditions. Every estimate is strictly positive, every weight is nonnegative, and at least one trading participant carries a strictly positive weight:

$$[\alpha/\beta]_i > 0 \text{ for all } i, \quad w_i \geq 0 \text{ for all } i, \quad \exists j : w_j > 0.$$

Claim. Under these conditions, there is exactly one strictly positive price at which the market is in equilibrium, and it is the one given by (9).

Proof. Consider the market behavior $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha$ of (11) as a function of the probe price $[\alpha/\beta]_z > 0$:

$$\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha([\alpha/\beta]_z) = \sum_i w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R}.$$

Each term with $w_i > 0$ is strictly increasing in $[\alpha/\beta]_z$, since

$$\frac{d}{d[\alpha/\beta]_z} \left[w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \right] = w_i \left(\frac{2[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i^2} + \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z^2} \right) > 0,$$

and each term with $w_i = 0$ vanishes identically. As at least one weight is strictly positive, $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha$ is strictly increasing on $(0, \infty)$. Moreover, $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha([\alpha/\beta]_z) \rightarrow -\infty$ as $[\alpha/\beta]_z \rightarrow 0^+$ (the $-[\alpha/\beta]_i / [\alpha/\beta]_z$ terms dominate) and $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha([\alpha/\beta]_z) \rightarrow +\infty$ as $[\alpha/\beta]_z \rightarrow \infty$ (the quadratic terms dominate). Since $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha$ is continuous and strictly increasing with these limits, it vanishes at exactly one $[\alpha/\beta]_z > 0$. By Annex 7.4, that zero is (9).

Q.E.D.

Corollary. Every term of $\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha$ is nonpositive at $[\alpha/\beta]_z = \min_i [\alpha/\beta]_i$ (all ratios $[\alpha/\beta]_z / [\alpha/\beta]_i \leq 1$) and nonnegative at $[\alpha/\beta]_z = \max_i [\alpha/\beta]_i$; the equilibrium price therefore always lies between the smallest and the largest estimate of the trading participants.

7.6 Proof that the total market behaves as a single participant

In (11), we defined the market behavior as the sum of the behavior of all its participants

$$\dot{X}_\Omega^\alpha = \sum_i w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R}.$$

We want to prove that there exists a total market weight W_Ω such that the market behaves as a single participant, in a way that

$$W_\Omega \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R} = \sum_i w_i \left(\left(\frac{[\alpha/\beta]_z}{[\alpha/\beta]_i} \right)^2 - \frac{[\alpha/\beta]_i}{[\alpha/\beta]_z} \right) \dot{R},$$

for any $[\alpha/\beta]_z$.

Of course, this statement is true in the trivial case when the inputs of each of the N_Ω participants are $[\alpha/\beta]_i = [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ and $w_i = W_\Omega/N_\Omega$, but we want to prove that it is in fact true for any participant's inputs.

By looking at the previous expression term by term, we conclude that for it to be true for any $[\alpha/\beta]_z$, we must satisfy both

$$\begin{aligned} W_\Omega [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^2 &= \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2 \quad \text{and} \\ W_\Omega [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega &= \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i. \end{aligned}$$

We can easily satisfy the second expression by setting

$$W_\Omega = [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i.$$

Now, we need to verify that this choice also satisfies the first expression

$$\begin{aligned} W_\Omega [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^2 &= \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2 \\ \left([\beta/\alpha]_\Omega \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i \right) [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^2 &= \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2 \\ [\beta/\alpha]_\Omega^3 \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i &= \sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2 \\ [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega &= \left(\frac{\sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i}{\sum_i w_i [\beta/\alpha]_i^2} \right)^{1/3}. \end{aligned}$$

The last line corresponds to the expression for the market price that we already proved in Annex 7.4.

Q.E.D.

7.7 Statistical interpretation of the equation for the total market weight

The equation defining the total market weight can be rearranged as

$$[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega = \sum_i \frac{w_i}{W_\Omega} [\alpha/\beta]_i.$$

Since the market price $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ is in some sense the weighted average of the participants' estimates $[\alpha/\beta]_i$, one can draw a parallel between the previous expression and the expected value of a random variable X , which is by definition

$$E[X] = \sum_i p_i x_i$$

where x_i is a particular outcome of the variable X and p_i is the probability of getting this particular outcome.

In this analogy, we have that:

$$\begin{aligned} X &\rightarrow [\alpha/\beta] , \\ E[X] &\rightarrow [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega , \\ p_i &\rightarrow \frac{w_i}{W_\Omega} , \\ x_i &\rightarrow [\alpha/\beta]_i . \end{aligned}$$

Now if $[\alpha/\beta]_\Omega$ is the expected value of the random variable $[\alpha/\beta]$, then we may ask what is its variance. The variance of a random variable can be calculated using

$$\text{Var}(X) = E[X^2] - (E[X])^2 .$$

Thus, we find that the quantity analogous to the variance of the participants' estimates is

$$\text{Var}(X) \rightarrow \frac{1}{W_\Omega} \sum_i w_i [\alpha/\beta]_i^2 - [\alpha/\beta]_\Omega^2 .$$

References

- [1] W. Kahan, "Pracniques: further remarks on reducing truncation errors," *Communications of the ACM*, vol. 8, no. 1, p. 40, 1965. <https://doi.org/10.1145/363707.363723>